



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Carden Memorial School

School Website: <https://cardenmemorial.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Carden Memorial School (Salt Lake City, UT)

Website audited: <https://www.cardenmemorialschool.com/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Carden Memorial School presents a robust classical Christian identity and practice. The website repeatedly affirms a classical purpose (cultivating "wisdom" and "virtue") and transcendental aims ("truth" and "beauty"), integrates theology across the curriculum, and maintains liturgical/communal devotional practices. The curriculum foregrounds the Trivium, Latin, Great Books/primary texts, and chronological history; pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, structured debate, and substantial use of memorization/recitation and singing. Parent partnership is explicit and active (weekly devotionals open to parents, community events, parent education content). The faculty section is the least explicit relative to the "teachers as models/mentors" and "faculty collegium" language in the classical lexicon, but testimonials and tour pages still show strong teacher formation and care. On balance, the school's public materials satisfy the Six Elements framework for a CLASSICAL judgment. Key pages: homepage and hero ("Classical Education for Children PreK-8th"), Trivium/logic/Socratic content, Latin and Great Books, weekly devotionals, parent resources and events.

Note on method: Keywords and criteria are drawn from "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School," including positive/negative indicators (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy; vs. values-neutrality, project-based/experiential-only), and the classicality lexicon referenced herein.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

Required criteria (Six Elements reference for indicators: transcendental moral realism; grounded in theology; liturgical/communal worship)

- Keyword evidence found on school site
 - Transcendentals/virtue: "truth and beauty," "wisdom," "virtue," "moral formation," "character"
 - Grounded in theology: "classical Christian school," "biblical principles," "integrating the sciences with ... theology"
 - Liturgical/communal practices: "Weekly Devotional," with "songs and prayers," "scripture," "student-led worship," and special services (Easter, Christmas, Thanksgiving)
- Mapping to Six Elements positive indicators
 - Truth, goodness, beauty; virtue/wisdom (positive)
 - Theology/faith and reason integration (positive)
 - Liturgy, hymnody, communal prayer (positive)
- Positive vs. Negative keyword tally (estimate)

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- Positive hits: 10 (truth, beauty, virtue, wisdom, Christian, biblical principles, scripture, devotionals, songs/prayers, theology)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 1.00; Percent coverage (3/3 criteria): 1.00
 - Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Required criteria (formation in wisdom/virtue; education as formation vs. information; belief in reality/knowability of the true, good, beautiful)

- Keyword evidence found on school site
 - “We ... nurture wisdom, virtue, and critical thinking ... blend rigorous academics with strong moral and spiritual foundations”
 - “Education that nurtures the whole child—mind, heart, and spirit ... moral formation ... truth and beauty”
- Mapping to Six Elements positive indicators
 - Wisdom, virtue, formation; truth, goodness, beauty (positive)
- Positive vs. Negative keyword tally (estimate)
 - Positive hits: 8 (wisdom, virtue, formation, character, whole child, truth, beauty, love of learning)
 - Negative hits: 1 (incidental “careers” mention in outcomes language)
 - Percent positive: 0.89; Percent coverage (3/3): 1.00
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

Required criteria (Trivium; history not reduced to “social studies”; Great Books/Great Conversation; cultivation of wonder)

- Keyword evidence found on school site
 - Trivium: explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric model; logic instruction; debates/discussions
 - Latin throughout grades; Quadrivium themes (music, astronomy) and explicit astronomy in grade 6
 - Great Books/primary texts: Aristotle, Plato, Shakespeare, Founding Fathers; “primary texts”
 - Chronological history study emphasized
 - Wonder/beauty highlighted in arts; “fostering a sense of wonder”
- Mapping to Six Elements positive indicators
 - Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books/primary sources; wonder/integration (positive)
- Negative signals noted
 - “Experience-Based Learning,” “hands-on work” appear occasionally (negative indicator when pedagogically dominant)
- Positive vs. Negative keyword tally (estimate)
 - Positive hits: 12 (Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Great Books, primary texts, chronological history, astronomy, music, wonder, integration)
 - Negative hits: 2 (experience-based; hands-on)
 - Percent positive: 0.86; Percent coverage (4/4): 1.00
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

Required criteria (restful/contemplative aspects; lower-school singing/chanting/memory; upper grades Socratic/discussion; rhetoric opportunities; K–8 can still be classical without 9–12 seminars)

- Keyword evidence found on school site
 - Socratic and debate: “Socratic discussions and structured debates” in logic instruction
 - Memory and recitation: “memorization and poetry recitation” explicitly valued in arts/language learning
 - Singing/music integrated across grades; choirs and concerts; weekly devotionals with songs/prayers (lower/upper school)
 - Rhetoric/oratory cues: public speaking emphasis in parent-focused content (school ethos of orality)
 - Restful learning ethos indirectly: “children should enjoy childhood” (scholé-adjacent tone)
- Mapping to Six Elements positive indicators
 - Socratic/dialectic; memorization/recitation; singing; restful learning (positive)
- Negative signals noted
 - “Experience-Based Learning” and “hands-on work” are present (negative when dominant)
- Positive vs. Negative keyword tally (estimate)
 - Positive hits: 8 (Socratic, debate, memorization, recitation, singing, choir, devotional songs, public speaking)
 - Negative hits: 2 (experience-based, hands-on)
 - Percent positive: 0.80; Percent coverage: 0.80 (meets all K–8-relevant elements; rhetoric/seminar as a formal HS program not applicable)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

Required criteria (teachers as models/mentors; faculty as “living curriculum”/collegial; portraits/profiles of teacher/student ideal)

- Keyword evidence found on school site
 - “Dedicated teachers ... passionate about fostering a love of learning,” “experts in their fields,” extra help and care beyond class time (testimonials)
- Mapping to Six Elements indicators
 - Implicit in tone (virtue/formational modeling), but the site lacks explicit “teachers as models of virtue,” “faculty collegium,” or a “portrait of a teacher” statement that would match the positive keyword set more directly
- Positive vs. Negative keyword tally (estimate)
 - Positive hits: 4 (dedicated, experts, passionate, after-school help)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 1.00; Percent coverage: 0.50 (mentoring/collegiality/portrait not explicit)
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

Required criteria (partnering with parents as co-educators; educating/serving parents; parents welcome to visit)

- Keyword evidence found on school site
 - “Educating students requires a team ... working with students and families.”
 - Parents welcomed at “field trips, weekly devotionals, and school functions”; frequent parent events (Back to School Night, devotionals, concerts, Founders’ Day, community-wide events)
 - “Tips for Parents” blog series (parent formation/involvement)
- Mapping to Six Elements positive indicators
 - Partnership with families; parent formation; cultural/liturgical community life (positive)

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- Positive vs. Negative keyword tally (estimate)
 - Positive hits: 7 (partnership, welcome to devotionals/events, Back to School Night, PTA noted on tour page, parent resources/blogs)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 1.00; Percent coverage (3/3): 1.00
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
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Aggregate Judgment

- Category ratings: Religious/Metaphysical (CLASSICAL), Purpose/Goal (CLASSICAL), Curriculum (CLASSICAL), Pedagogy (CLASSICAL), Faculty (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL), Parents/Community (CLASSICAL)
- Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Why: The school's public materials align closely with the Six Elements' positive indicators across identity, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, and community. Faculty language is supportive but less explicit relative to the classical lexicon, which slightly tempers that category only.

Source highlights (select)

- Classical Christian identity and purpose (wisdom, virtue, truth/beauty; whole child/moral formation)
 - Theology integration and weekly devotional worship practices with songs/prayers and Scripture
 - Trivium/logic/Socratic discussion; Latin; Great Books/primary texts; chronological history; wonder/arts integration
 - Parent partnership, formation, and welcome into the school's devotional and community life
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.